# fn make_rappor

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This proof resides in **"contrib"** because it has not completed the vetting process.

Proves soundness of `make_rappor` in `mod.rs` at commit 304ef9c2 (outdated[1]).
TODO: algorithm outline

## 1 Hoare Triple

### 1.1 Preconditions

- Variable `f` must be of type `f64`
- Variable `m` must be of type `u32`
- Variable `constant_time` must be of type `bool`

### Pseudocode

```
def make_rappor(f: f64, constant_time: bool):
    input_domain: VectorDomain<AtomDomain<bool>>,
    input_metric: DiscreteDistance,
    output_domain = VectorDomain<AtomDomain<bool>>
    output_measure = MaxDivergence

    if (f <= 0.0 or f > 1):
        raise Exception("probability must be in (0.0, 1]")

    eps = (2*m)*log((2-f)/f)
    def privacy_map(d_in: IntDistance):
        return eps

    def function(arg: Vec<bool>) -> Vec<bool>:
        for b in arg:
          b = b ⊻ bool.sample_bernoulli(f/2, constant_time)
        return arg

    return Measurement(input_domain, function, input_metric, output_measure, privacy_map)
```

### Postcondition

For every setting of the input parameters `(f, m, constant_time)` to `make_rappor` such that the given preconditions hold,

[1] See new changes with `git diff 304ef9c2..e4529a3e rust/src/measurements/rappor/mod.rs`

`make_rappor` raises an exception (at compile time or run time) or returns a valid measurement. A valid measurement has the following property:

1. (Privacy guarantee). For every pair of elements $u, v$ in `input_domain` and for every pair (`d_in`, `d_out`), where `d_in` has the associated type for `input_metric` and `d_out` has the associated type for `output_measure`, if $u, v$ are `d_in`-close under `input_metric`, `privacy_map`(`d_in`) does not raise an exception, and `privacy_map`(`d_in`) $\leq$ `d_out`, then `function`($u$), `function`($v$) are `d_out`-close under `output_measure`.

## 2 Proof

1. Privacy guarantee

> **Note 1** (Proof relies on correctness of Bernoulli sampler)**.** The following proof makes use of the following lemma that asserts the correctness of the Bernoulli sampler function.
>
> **Lemma 2.1.** If system entropy is not sufficient, `sample_bernoulli` raises an error. Otherwise, `sample_bernoulli(f/2, constant_time)`, the Bernoulli sampler function used in `make_randomized_response_bool`, returns `true` with probability (`prob`) and returns `false` with probability (1 - `f/2`).

**Theorem 2.2.** [1] `make_rappor` satisfies $\varepsilon$-DP where

$$\varepsilon = 2m \log\left(\frac{2-f}{f}\right)$$

**Lemma 2.3.**

$$P[y_i = 1 \mid x_i = 1] = 1 - \frac{1}{2}f \tag{1}$$

$$P[y_i = 1 \mid x_i = 0] = \frac{1}{2}f \tag{2}$$

*Proof.* Let $Y = y_1, ..., y_k$ be a randomised report generated by `make_rappor`. Then the probability of observing any given report $Y$ is $P[Y = y|X = x]$. $x = x_1, ..., x_k$ is a single Boolean vector with at most $m$ ones. Without loss of generality assume that $x^* = \{x_1 = 1, ..., x_m = 1, x_{m+1} = 0, ..., x_k = 0\}$, then we have

$$P[Y = y \mid X = x^*] = \prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \times \prod_{i=m+1}^{k} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i}$$

Then let $D$ be the ratio of two such conditional probabilities with distinct values $x_1$ and $x_2$, and let $S$

be the range of `make_rappor`.

$$
\begin{aligned}
D &= \frac{P[Y \in S \mid X = x_1]}{P[Y \in S \mid X = x_2]} \qquad (3)\\
&= \frac{\sum_{y \in S} P[Y = y \mid X = x_1]}{\sum_{y \in S} P[Y = y \mid X = x_2]}\\
&\leq \max_{y \in S} \frac{P[Y = y \mid X = x_1]}{P[Y = y \mid X = x_2]}\\
&= \max_{y \in S} \frac{\prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \times \prod_{i=m+1}^{k} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i}}{\prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \times \prod_{i=m+1}^{2m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \times \prod_{i=2m+1}^{k} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i}}\\
&= \max_{y \in S} \frac{\prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \times \prod_{i=m+1}^{2m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i}}{\prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \times \prod_{i=m+1}^{2m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{1-y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{y_i}}\\
&= \max_{y \in S} \left[\prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{2(1-y_i)} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{2y_i} \times \prod_{i=m+1}^{2m} \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{2y_i} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{2(1-y_i)}\right] \qquad (4)
\end{aligned}
$$

Equation 4 is maximised when $y_1 = 1, ..., y_m = 1$, and $y_{m+1}, ..., y_{2m} = 0$, giving

$$
\begin{aligned}
D &\leq \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right)^{2m} \times \left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)^{-2m}\\
&= \left(\frac{2-f}{f}\right)^{2m}
\end{aligned}
$$

Therefore,

$$
\varepsilon = 2m \log\left(\frac{2-f}{f}\right) \qquad (5)
$$

□

2. Utility

**Theorem 2.4.** The expected value of `debias_basic_rappor` is $N$.

*Proof.* Let $Y$ be the sum of received randomised outputs of `make_rappor`, where $Y_i$ is the number of received bits at index $i \in [k]$. Let $N_i$ be the true number of times bit $i$ was set.

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}[Y_i] &= N_i \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right) + (n - N_i)\frac{f}{2}\\
&= N_i(1-f) + n\frac{1}{2}f
\end{aligned}
$$

Therefore the estimator $\hat{N}_i$, given by

$$
\hat{N}_i = \frac{Y_i - n\frac{f}{2}}{1-f} \qquad (6)
$$

is unbiased as,

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{N}_i] = N_i \tag{7}$$

□

**Theorem 2.5.** `debias_basic_rappor` has average squared error

$$l_2^2(N - \hat{N}) = kn\left(\frac{f^2 - 2f}{4(f-1)}\right)$$

*Proof.* Notice that each $\hat{N}_i$ is a sum of $n$ Bernoullis with probability $1 - \frac{1}{2}f$ or $\frac{1}{2}f$, which both have $\sigma^2 = \frac{1}{2}f\left(1 - \frac{1}{2}f\right) = \frac{f}{2} - \frac{f^2}{4}$

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}[|\hat{N} - N|] &= \mathbb{E}[\sum_{i=1}^{k}(\hat{N}_i - N_i)^2] = \sum_{i=1}^{k}\mathbb{E}[(\hat{N}_i - N_i)^2] \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{k}\mathbb{E}[(\hat{N}_i - \mathbb{E}[\hat{N}_i])^2] && \text{by Theorem 2.4} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{k}\mathrm{Var}(\hat{N}_i) = \sum_{i=1}^{k}\frac{\mathrm{Var}(\hat{Y}_i)}{1-f} && \text{by Equation 6} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{k} n\left(\frac{\frac{f}{2} - \frac{f^2}{4}}{1-f}\right) \\
&= kn\left(\frac{f^2 - 2f}{4(f-1)}\right)
\end{aligned}$$

□

# References


[1] Úlfar Erlingsson, Vasyl Pihur, and Aleksandra Korolova. Rappor: Randomized aggregatable privacy-preserving ordinal response. In *Proceedings of the 21st ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security*, Scottsdale, Arizona, 2014.